

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter **The Daily Ceilidh**
in association with

BERNERA CHRISTMAS FAIR



4TH December 2021 / 12noon-4pm

Bernera Community Association, Breaclea, HS2 9LT

**LOCAL BUSINESSES & CRAFTS • FUN & GAMES FOR ALL •
REINDEER RACING • CHILDREN'S HAVE A GO CRAFT TABLE •
SANTA'S GROTTO • CHRISTMAS CHOIR • & LOTS MORE**

ELVES KITCHEN OPEN 12-4PM

HOT FOOD AND DRINK AVAILABLE TO SIT IN OR TAKE AWAY

Local crafts and businesses including:

Avon - Toiletries, cosmetics and gifts for all the family
Bernera Bakes - Home baked cakes and goodies
Body Shop - Toiletries and gifts from the Body Shop
Charly Hamlyn Ceramics - Local made pottery and ceramics
Croft Crafts - Tweed cushions, stools, knitted hats and Xmas bits and bobs
Croit Crystals - Crystals and jewellery
Forage - Christmas hampers, cheeseboards and produce
Froach Knits - Knitted and crochet hats, scarves, blankets, headbands
Ros Paterson, artist - paintings, minis, "wearables" and other painty things
Tropics Skincare - Toiletries, skincare and gifts
Uig Candles - Handcrafted candles, soy wax melts and reed diffusers
Wild Shores Jewellery Design - Original sterling silver jewellery by a local silversmith

To enquire about hiring a stall or to book a time slot for Santa's grotto
call **01851 600159** or WhatsApp **07958 549784**

Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk
Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

IN MEMORIAM - JOAN MACAULAY 1959 - 2021



On Thursday 30th September 2021 it was a cold, wet and miserable day filled with grief and sadness, as our beloved Joan, a Wife, Mother, Sister, Grandmother, and Auntie left 16b Tong to make her final journey home to Great Bernera, where she was laid to rest at Bosta Cemetery.

Joan was born Joan Campbell on the 18th of July 1959 where she lived and grew up in 16b Tong. This was her family home with her mother, Mary Flora Campbell, her father, Donald John Campbell, her brother, Angus and her two sisters Chrisell and Catherine. Once Joan finished school she went travelling for a year, she travelled round the world and made many new friends and fantastic memories. On Joan's return to Lewis she met the love of her life, Neil. They married and worked together as a steadfast team to build a very successful fishing company in Bernera, all the while building their family home in Kirkibost. This is where they brought up their three daughters together, Amanda, Jacqueline, and Carolyn.

Joan was a very kind, caring, selfless and thoughtful person. She was a devoted wife and the most wonderful and inspirational mother to her daughters. Her kind and selfless nature is what inspired her to start a club called the "soup and sandwich" Club in Bernera. This was a voluntary club which Joan started to enable the elderly and vulnerable in the Bernera community to gain some independence, and provided a lifeline for those who would not normally get out or see many people. The club was so popular it attracted between 30/40 members and ran for over 15 years.

Joan was instrumental in meticulously organising fundraising events to raise funds for an annual trip to hot spots round the UK and Ireland. For many this was the highlight to their year and would not have been possible otherwise.

Along with the S.A.S club Joan volunteered herself to assisting on all the local committees at various times over the years. Joan has tirelessly devoted herself to the sustainable developments in the Bernera Community, and her voluntary roles varied from club secretary to Community Council Chairperson. Alongside these voluntary roles Joan retrained and worked with counselling and family mediation for 5 years then she had a change of career and was employed by CNES for 20 years. Firstly, as a community coordinator and was then successful in gaining her post as a development officer until she retired last year. After her retirement Joan then joined Crossroads, Lewis as a support worker. She was valued by their team and also to those whom she cared for and is great loss to them all.

One of the happiest days of Joan's life was the day she became a Granny. She devoted herself to her grandchildren - they were her life, and brought her endless amounts of joy and happiness. Joan has four grandchildren with a fifth on the way in March. Kiera, Owen, Hamish, and Lachie will miss their Granny more than words can say and will never forget how special she was.

Joan was diagnosed with secondary liver metastases on 24th August 2021 and after various scans and tests she was told on the 13th September that she had a very rare and aggressive cancer called Neuroendocrine cancer. This cancer starts in the hormones and is extremely difficult to diagnose until it is too late. Joan was given the most devastating news on the 13th September, the words will echo in the ears of her family for ever – there was no treatment that would help and she was given "months at best" to live.

Joan's character shone through as she battled with this horrific disease, she was so courageous and determined that she crammed so much into the last weeks of her life – she never gave up, a true inspiration. Joan then sadly passed away peacefully at 16b Tong with all her family around her on Monday 27th September 2021 at 11:50, only two weeks after getting her diagnosis.

Joan has left an unimaginable void in the hearts of her family and we will all miss her dearly. We would also like to pay tribute to the two wonderful nurses that gave Joan extraordinary and compassionate care in her last days with us. Thank you Meg and Lesley.

HEBMENHEALTH

A new peer support group for men in the Western Isles who would like some support with their mental health is to be launched this month. The group aims to meet each week over a cup of tea or coffee, giving a safe space to talk openly about mental health, including suicidal thoughts. The first meeting will take place in the Failte Centre, Bayhead in Stornoway on Saturday 27th November at 7.30pm. All are welcome.

THE SALVATION ARMY CHRISTMAS PRESENT APPEAL 2021

Throughout November The Salvation Army in Stornoway collect new and unopened toys, wrapping paper and chocolate / treats for families across the Western Isles who may need that extra help. They provide toys for children and young adults from 0 - 18 years old.

Last year, thanks to the generosity of those in the islands they were able to help 255 children have a more special Christmas day. If you would like to get involved there are a number of drop off points across town as well as The Salvation Army hall, including in Tesco, Argos, the airport, Stornoway Golf Club, and The Oystercatchers gift shop.

For those unable to get into town please contact us at the Daily Ceilidh on **01851 600159** and we'll arrange to collect and donate on your behalf.

WESTERN ISLES WOMEN'S AID

If you or anyone you know is experiencing abuse please contact Western Isles Women's Aid for support on **01851 704750** or take a look at their website **www.wiwasty.co.uk**

A recently shared piece on their facebook page, by Maria Consiglio, helps to remind us that abuse is not always physical:

People would always say "I would never let anyone treat me like that." They don't realise abuse is not always physical or outright verbal. Some abuse is more insidious and starts out slow, with continuous small indiscretions, until they program you to accept their bad behaviours. It's punishing you with emotional distance, and making you feel unworthy. It's slowly ignoring your wants and needs, making you feel unloved or unimportant. It's a progressive manipulation, where you ultimately find yourself wondering how you ever got in that position.

TAKE A FRESH LOOK AT WHAT MEDICINES YOU TAKE

Many people have been taking the same repeat prescription for a while and are unsure how effective it is, or even if the medicines are still required.

Patients may also be unsure why a medicine has been prescribed, or how often it should be taken. They may also have stopped taking certain medicines due to side effects, without first discussing this with their GP or pharmacist.

NHS Western Isles are encouraging anyone who is not sure, or would like to discuss their medication in more depth, to talk to your GP practice or Community Pharmacist. Alternatively contact your GP practice in order to make an appointment with the Primary Care Pharmacy team.

NEWS FROM THE MUSEUM

The Museum and Iron Age House remained closed during 2021 as the trustees felt that the risk of opening and the Covid requirements for ventilation, hygiene and distancing were difficult to manage and could put visitors and volunteers at risk, something they felt was not worth taking a chance on. However, activity has continued with queries and surveys to be answered, continued improvements to the collection and activities to follow up on.



On Wednesday 29th September naturalist Stewart McPherson and a film crew visited the Iron Age House to film a sequence for an upcoming series called Britain's Secret Islands. This is a follow up series to Britain's Treasure Islands that Stewart previously made and was shown on BBC Four. It is expected that this series will be shown in June 2022. Stewart is writing a companion book to go with the series and he plans to donate copies to 8000 UK schools. This will include a chapter on Lewis, with a section on the Iron Age House.

With the new Bridge nearing completion new Information Boards are being produced to set up at the Bernera end of the Bridge.

East Loch Roag Comunn Eachdraidh are working on a family tree database of local families and the Bernera Comunn Eachdraidh have been working with them to supply information linking Bernera and Tir Mor families, mainly through marriage, for this database. For the past year the Comunn Eachdraidh has been working with the PERICLES project, a european wide collaboration to enable sustainable usage of maritime and coastal cultural heritage. Initially providing information on our Bernera Historical sites, then more recently bringing these together in a walking and a driving tour on the website. The links for these are below and worth a look if you get the chance.

<https://www.pericles-heritage.eu/> for the whole Website

<https://www.izi.travel/en/browse/e5405a82-5a81-4007-b103-0f224cdf53e3/en> for the walking tour.

<https://www.izi.travel/en/browse/6375524a-e7a4-4d17-97fa-c6429138ed9d/en> for the driving tour.

ALL SORTS CLUB

The members of the All Sorts Club would like to thank the Stornoway Angling Association for their recent donation. The fishermen, who fish the Grimersta River amongst others, collect fees and donate these to Lewis community groups from time to time; we will use this money to help pay for our trips out, which everyone enjoys.

As always, new members are always welcome and we hope that now restrictions are being lifted you will feel easier about meeting up and getting out of the house. We meet every Wednesday between 2pm and 4pm in the back hall of the community centre, please use the back north door.

SPEAK GAELIC

Are you interested in learning gaelic? Would you like to do so from the comfort of your own home, via zoom? Uig Learners gaelic lessons are due to start this November using the new "Speak Gaelic" learning programme as launched at the Mod in October. For learning in a fun and friendly environment, with plenty of support, or simply to find out more, get in touch with uiglearners@gmail.com

AN SEANN DOILE AGUS AN DOILE ÙR



Là neo dhà air ais bha mi a' bruidhinn ri caraaid mu thachartasan nuair a bha sinn nar nigheanan beaga. Dh' innis mi dhi mun àm a dh' fhuirich mi còmhla ri caraidean mo phàrantan fhad 's a bha mo mhàthair san ospadal. Às dèidh làimhe, chuimhnich mi air rudeigin eile mu na làithean sin agus shaoil mi gun sgrìobhinn mu dhèidhinn.

Nuair a bha mi glè bheag fhathast, fhuair mi tiodhlac na Nollaige sònraichte: doile mhòr, b' Crìosaidh a h-ainm. Far an deach mise, chaidh ise. Mar sin bha i còmhla rium aig an taigh sin cuideachd.

Aon latha chuir mi romham an doile a nìghe anns an amar. Gu mi - fhortanach thuit na sùilean a broinn a cinn. Abair tubaist! Ach cha robh mi brònach oir bha i na mo leanabh fhathast.

Às dèidh beagan sheachdainean thill mi dhachaigh agus bha mo mhàthair feargach nuair a chunnaic i Crìosaidh. Thuirt i nach fhaodainn mi "an rud grànnda sin" a thoirt a-mach às an taigh, mur a deidheadh i dhan bhiona sgudail! Thoisich mi a' rànaid ach cha b' urrainn dhomh càil sam bith a dheanamh. Beagan mhìosan às dèidh sin bha an ceathramh co-là-breith agam ann is fhuair mi doile ùr. Bha i cho àlainn, sùbailte is bog, le falt fada bàn An toiseach bha mi glè thoilichte gus an tuirt mamaidh: "Uill, tha doile snog ùr agad a-nis. Tilgidh sinn Crìosaidh dhan bhiona - sgudail!" Dè bha i ag radh? Abair briseadh - dùil! Thionn daidh an subhachas gu dubhachas gu h-obann.

Cha tuirt mi smid ach smaoinich mi rium fhìn nach tachradh sin a-chaidh!

Chaidh na làithean seachad agus aon latha thàinig nàbaidh a chèlidh air mo mhàthair. Bha iadsan a' bruidhinn san chidsin ach bha mise anns an t-seòmair-suidhe le siosar!

Chaidh mi am falach air cùl an t-sòfa agus grios mi an doile! 'S e gnìomh oillteil a bh' ann gun teagamh ach aig an àm sin cha robh mi duilich idir, idir, An àite bha mi air mo dhòigh glan oir bha Crìosaidh air a sàbhalach mu dheireadh thall.

Linne Macleod
Dun Innes



BERNERA BAKES... THE ULTIMATE ALL SEASONS SALAD

INGREDIENTS:

2 Little Gem lettuces
1x100g packet mixed rocket and chard
1x70g packet lamb's lettuce
6 small cherry tomatoes
1x70g packet Milano salami slices
6 slices Parma ham
100g black seedless grapes
1x200g jar artichokes in oil
150g feta cheese

Salt and freshly ground black pepper
50g pine nuts, toasted
A few shavings of Parmesan
HONEY AND MUSTARD DRESSING:

1 tbsp runny honey
1 tbsp Dijon mustard
6 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
3 tbsp white wine vinegar
1 tsp caster sugar



METHOD:

1. Tear the Little Gem leaves into manageable pieces. To assemble the salad, arrange all the salad leaves over the base of the platter. Slice the tomatoes in half and arrange over the leaves.

2. Fold the salami into cone shapes and arrange over the top. Trim any excess fat from the Parma ham and cut each slice in half. Pinch into little piles and arrange on the salad, along with the grapes and artichoke pieces. Crumble the feta into large pieces and sprinkle on to the arrangement.

3. Season with salt and pepper, scatter over the pine nuts and Parmesan. For the dressing, measure the ingredients into a bowl and whisk by hand until smooth. Season with salt and pepper.

4. Drizzle the dressing over the salad just before serving.

Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



LINDA NORGROVE FOUNDATION UPDATE 2021



A lot of Bernera residents will already know of the work of the Linda Norgrove Foundation, which was set up just over ten years ago by John and Lorna Norgrove in memory of their daughter. Many people in the area will also know John and Lorna, who have lived on Lewis since 1975. Over the past couple of months LNF has been back in the national news as journalists look to get a better understanding of the situation women face as the Taliban take power in Afghanistan. We thought we would take this opportunity to give both an update about the current work of the foundation and the news of the evacuation of our Afghan staff members.

LNF is currently sponsoring just over 160 female students in Afghanistan – the majority studying medicine, midwifery, and nursing. The students are being allowed to continue with their studies at the moment but, as with many aspects of life under the new Taliban regime, a lot remains uncertain. We strongly believe that access to education not only helps transform the lives of the scholarship students but also benefits their families and their communities. We have given a commitment to these students that we will support them through to graduation and we will continue to work with them, and our partners in Afghanistan, to enable them access to education where possible.

Some of our students are sponsored directly by people in the UK. Please get in touch if you would like to find out more about this. We were over the moon to welcome Frishta and Farzana Matin and their families to the Isle of Lewis, when they arrived at a very wet and windy Stornoway airport on the 26th October. They had left their homes mid-August. Initially we believed that they would be evacuated from Kabul but the chaos at the airport, coupled with attacks at the gates, meant that it was not possible for them to board a flight, even though they were on both US and UK evacuation lists. Showing a huge amount of strength and patience the family, which includes four adults and an 11-month-old baby, travelled to the north of Afghanistan and then spent weeks moving from halls to guests houses, and even a wedding venue, before boarding a flight out of Mazar-e-Sharif. The family were flown first to Qatar and then on to Edinburgh to quarantine before arriving in the Outer Hebrides, on what must have been the worst weather day of the year.... ..so far! They are now taking some time to make plans for their future in Scotland and will continue to support the work of the Foundation in Afghanistan.

We organise an annual 10K – held on the Valtos peninsula each October - and for the past two years have also run an outdoor swimming challenge in the summer. If you would like to find out more about the work of LNF or have any fundraising ideas, please get in touch with

sophie.brown@lindanorgrovefoundation.org

REMEMBRANCE

Each November people across the UK come together to remember the sacrifice of the Armed Forces community from Britain and the Commonwealth. Remembrance also pays tribute to the special contribution of families and of the emergency services, as well as acknowledging innocent civilians who have lost their lives in conflict and acts of terrorism.

Remembrance does not glorify war and its symbol, the red poppy, is a sign of both remembrance and hope for a peaceful future. The act of remembrance unites people of all faiths, cultures, and backgrounds but it is also deeply personal.

In every act of remembrance, we honour the memory of the fallen and pledge to care for the living. We will remember them.

On Sunday 14th November, representatives from our local community joined together for Remembrance, with wreaths being laid at the War Memorial in Breaclete. Thanks go out to all of those who were involved, from organising the wreaths to laying them, and those who attended.

INFORMATION ON THE BCA PETROL PRICES.



Some of you may have noticed that we have recently had a large jump in fuel prices and might be wondering why it jumped so rapidly, rather than going up incrementally as it does in Stornoway.

We adjust the price when Highland Fuels fill it up, but sometimes there is a large gap of time inbetween refills. Rather than increasing the prices to match the ones in Stornoway, we only put the price up when we get a new delivery. In the summer with a higher turnover of fuel, that means they are likely to change more steadily. In the winter, the price will not fluctuate as regularly as we are selling so much less than in the summer, which means

there will be suddenly a large rise (or fall). The petrol price is charged at the rate we get it from Highland Fuels, plus a small margin to cover costs like electricity, insurance and broadband etc, so sometimes we make a bit more due to volume.

Please consider buying your fuel locally as it supports our efforts to provide the service to the community cost effectively, as we rely on those purchases to keep up with the costs.

Callum Macaulay
Kirkibost



GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST

Great Bernera Community Development Trust - Freelance Project Co-ordinator

Fee: £5,400 including expenses based on 360 hours work - Fixed Term: 31st March 2022

Great Bernera Community Development Trust is seeking to recruit an outgoing and self-motivated individual to support our residents to re-engage with the variety of groups, clubs, activities and services in our community. The post holder will work under the direction of the Community Development Trust to promote various opportunities to engage and participate in community life post-pandemic and to share these opportunities through a website, social media, telephone and in print.

Applicants must have excellent communication skills, a keen interest in the work of the land trusts and a willingness to work outside normal office hours as required. The ability to work unsupervised is essential.

This post is funded by The Scottish Government through Highlands and Islands Enterprise.

For further information please contact Anne Ryan, Chair, Great Bernera Community Development Trust.
trustbernera@hotmail or telephone **07786963481**

CLOSING DATE FOR APPLICATIONS IS 5pm on 6th December 2021



The Great Bernera Development Trust recently launched a questionnaire to enable Bernera and Tir Mor residents to have a say on how the derelict Scottish Salmon Hatchery building might be repurposed for the community's use. The consultation closed on the 31st of October and the response was terrific. We had 13 responses from islanders and the overwhelming message was that it should be useful for the community (and visitors) for a variety of commercial, social business and light industrial purposes. Very few of the ideas were single use ideas, where one idea for use would occupy the whole building. The ideas ranged from a social tap to small business units for creative and light industrial operations; a multi-purpose food processing unit for meat and fish with chill blaster to laundry and ironing facilities; and so much more. We thank you all for your careful and thoughtful responses.

The GBCDT and Bernera News are running a poll which can be found here: <https://bit.ly/GBCDTPoll> and on the GBCDT Facebook page. If you have any queries or need help with the poll, you can contact Julia Higginbottom via whatsapp on **07894516609** and she will help direct your inquiry.

DEADLINES

Deadlines are a constant reality of life. Be it to do with our work, community, recreational or personal appointments. Each one requiring attention, commitment, and organisation.

The story is told of an old Norwegian man who kept detailed and exhaustive notes about his life in a series of notebooks kept on a shelf at work. On his 80th birthday he pulled one of the notebooks off the shelf and began to read and to reflect on his life.

He was amazed to learn that he had spent five of these eighty years waiting for other people to turn up. Six months tying his tie. Three months telling children to be quiet and eight days telling his dogs to lie down.

It is unlikely that any of us would be able to do what this man did. But it would be an interesting exercise to log what we did across a day or a week of our life. The results may startle us. As we learn just how much of our time we spend on social media. Enslaved to the noise alarms of our iPhones and/or our laptops as another social media message or e-mail notifications requiring our immediate attention and response heralds its arrival.

The 'screen time' function of our iPhones and equivalent apps. for Android starkly tell us how much time we spend in the artificial world of the internet superhighway. Paradoxically, the more connected we become digitally, the more we may feel isolated and lonely personally.

Essential and beneficial as social media is, it cannot replace the tangible benefits of personal, physical, face-to-face meetings with our family, friends, and colleagues. In one's home, on our crofts or in our workplaces.

It is not without reason that God reminds us in the Bible that we are not to forsake the assembling of ourselves together. We have not been made to be alone but to be in community. And if that is true in the spiritual realm as the family of God to worship and pray to God together it is also true for the communities in which we live.

Loneliness can result in low mood, despondency, and despair. Yet a simple 5-minute visit to our neighbours next door or a short trip to visit family and friends on the other side of Great Bernera can result in them being encouraged. And our community strengthened.

As Jesus Himself reminds us, not only are we to 'love the Lord our God with all our heart, with all our soul, and with all our mind., but we are to love our neighbour as ourselves.'

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ ANSWERS

- | | | |
|------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|
| 1. Frodo Baggins | 12. Murmuration | 23. 1812 |
| 2. World Health Organisation | 13. Tooth Fairy | 24. William Wordsworth |
| 3. M6 | 14. Laughing Cow | 25. Moat Brae |
| 4. Wensleydale | 15. Crop Rotation | 26. Dumfries |
| 5. Stuart | 16. John Knox | 27. Murano Glass |
| 6. Jean Luc Picard | 17. The Sun | 28. Mallard |
| 7. Cherry | 18. Greyfriars Bobby | 29. Jenners |
| 8. Davos | 19. Svalbard | 30. Calcutta Cup |
| 9. Robert Burns | 20. Soweto | |
| 10. Judaism | 21. Beatles | |
| 11. Silver Back | 22. Atlantis | |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

